THE PRIME MINISTER'S OFFICE

REGIONAL ADMINISTRATION AND LOCAL GOVERNMENT

LONGIDO DISTRICT MID TERM JOINT EXAMINATION

FORM ONE — 036 COMPUTER SCIENCE

MARKING SCHEME — SEPTEMBER 2026

SECTION A (15 MARKS)

1. Multiple Choice Questions — 10 Marks

Question	Answer
(i)	B
(ii)	C
(iii)	B
(iv)	A
(v)	C
(vi)	B
(vii)	A
(viii)	A
(ix)	B
(x)	B

2. Matching Items — 5 Marks

Item	Answer
(i)	B
(ii)	C
(iii)	D
(iv)	A
(v)	E

SECTION B (70 MARKS)

3. (a) Define Computer Science. (3 marks)

Computer Science is the study of computers, information, computation and computational processes, including how computer systems are designed and used to solve problems.

(b) State three areas where Computer Science is useful in everyday life. Any three:

(i) Education
(ii) Banking and financial services
(iii) Communication
(iv) Health/medicine
(v) Transport
(vi) Business
(vii) Entertainment
(viii) Agriculture
(ix) Government services

(c) Explain two ways in which learning Computer Science can help a student in school and in the future. Any two well-explained points:

(i) Improves problem-solving and logical-thinking skills.
(ii) Helps students use computers and digital technologies effectively.
(iii) Supports research, learning and access to educational resources.
(iv) Provides useful skills for future employment and careers.
(v) Helps students understand programming and technology.

4. (a) What is a computer system? (3 marks)

A computer system is a combination of hardware, software, data and/or users/procedures working together to input, process, store and produce information.

(b) Name three major components of a computer system. (3 marks)

(i) Hardware
(ii) Software
(iii) Data
(iv) People/users
(v) Procedures

(c) Explain how two of the components work together to enable a computer to perform a task. (4 marks)

• Hardware consists of the physical parts of the computer.
• Software provides instructions for the hardware.
• The software sends instructions to hardware such as the CPU.
• The hardware carries out the instructions to perform the required task.

5. (a) Define computer hardware. (3 marks)

Computer hardware refers to the physical parts/components of a computer system that can be seen and touched.

(b) State the functions of three hardware devices. (3 marks)

Any three:
Keyboard — used to enter text, numbers and commands.
Mouse — used to point, select and control items on the screen.
Monitor — displays information and results.
Printer — produces hard copies of information.
CPU — processes instructions and controls computer operations.

(c) Distinguish between input devices and output devices.

Input devices: Devices used to enter data or instructions into a computer. Example: Keyboard or mouse.
Output devices: Devices used to present processed information from a computer to the user. Example: Monitor or printer.

6. (a) What is computer software? (3 marks)

Computer software is a set of programs/instructions that tells a computer what to do or how to perform particular tasks.

(b) Name three examples of computer software. (3 marks)

Any three:
(i) Microsoft Word
(ii) Windows
(iii) Microsoft Excel
(iv) Google Chrome
(v) PowerPoint
(vi) Paint
(vii) Antivirus software
(viii) VLC Media Player

(c) Explain the difference between system software and application software, giving one example of each. (4 marks)

System software: Manages and controls computer hardware and provides a platform for other software. Example: Windows operating system.
Application software: Designed to help users perform specific tasks. Example: Microsoft Word.

7. (a) State three rules for proper handling and care. (3 marks)

Any three:
(i) Keep food and drinks away from computers.
(ii) Handle keyboards, mice and other equipment gently.
(iii) Do not pull cables forcefully.
(iv) Keep computers clean and free from dust.
(v) Cover computers when they are not in use.
(vi) Keep computers in a well-ventilated place.
(vii) Switch computers off properly after use.

(b) Identify three unsafe practices shown in the scenario. (3 marks)

The unsafe practices include:
(i) Eating food near the computer.
(ii) Pulling cables forcefully.
(iii) Any implication of careless handling. However, covering the computer after use is a safe practice and should not be penalised.

Since the scenario explicitly gives only two unsafe practices, award the third mark for identifying another relevant unsafe practice from the student's explanation, such as careless handling or failure to keep equipment clean, if appropriately justified.

(c) Explain two possible effects of poor handling and care. (4 marks)

Any two:
(i) Computer components may become damaged.
(ii) Electrical faults or short circuits may occur if liquids are spilled.
(iii) Dust may cause overheating and reduce performance.
(iv) Cables may become damaged, causing loss of power or connectivity.
(v) Repairs and replacement costs may increase.
(vi) The useful life of the computer may be reduced.

8. (a) What is meant by computer system maintenance? (3 marks)

Computer system maintenance is the regular care, cleaning, checking, updating and repair of computer systems to keep them working properly and efficiently.

(b) State three maintenance activities. (3 marks)

Any three:
(i) Cleaning dust from the computer and keyboard.
(ii) Updating the operating system and software.
(iii) Running antivirus scans.
(iv) Removing unnecessary files.
(v) Checking and arranging cables.
(vi) Checking hardware for faults.
(vii) Backing up important data.
(viii) Ensuring proper ventilation.

(c) Explain two benefits of regular computer maintenance. (4 marks)

Any two:
(i) Improves computer performance and speed.
(ii) Prevents or reduces hardware/software problems.
(iii) Extends the useful life of computer equipment.
(iv) Protects data from some forms of malware or data loss.
(v) Reduces repair and replacement costs.
(vi) Improves reliability.

9. (a) What is meant by computer troubleshooting? (3 marks)

Troubleshooting is the systematic process of identifying, diagnosing and correcting problems or faults in a computer system.

(b) State three things to check before concluding that the computer is damaged. (3 marks)

Any three:
(i) Check whether the power cable is properly connected.
(ii) Check whether the power socket/switch is working.
(iii) Check whether the computer's power button has been pressed correctly.
(iv) Check whether the monitor is switched on.
(v) Check the monitor's power and display cables.
(vi) Check whether other connected devices/cables are properly connected.

(c) Describe two general steps that should be followed when solving a computer problem. (4 marks)

Any two well-described steps:
(i) Identify and understand the problem — observe the symptoms and determine what is not working correctly.
(ii) Check possible causes and test solutions — inspect connections, settings or components and apply an appropriate solution.

SECTION C (15 MARKS)

10. Essay — 15 marks

A. Proper handling and care — 4 marks

(i) Keep food and drinks away from computers.
(ii) Handle equipment gently.
(iii) Do not pull or bend cables forcefully.
(iv) Keep computers covered when not in use.
(v) Keep the laboratory clean and dust-free.
(vi) Ensure proper ventilation.
(vii) Switch computers off correctly.
Maximum: 4 marks

B. Simple computer maintenance — 3 marks

Relevant points include:
(i) Clean keyboards, monitors and other equipment.
(ii) Remove dust regularly.
(iii) Keep cables properly arranged.
(iv) Update software and operating systems.
(v) Run antivirus checks.
(vi) Delete unnecessary files.
(vii) Back up important data.
Maximum: 3 marks

C. Preventing common computer problems — 3 marks

Relevant points include:
(i) Avoid spilling liquids on computers.
(ii) Protect computers from dust and overheating.
(iii) Use antivirus software and keep it updated.
(iv) Avoid installing unknown or unnecessary software.
(v) Shut down computers properly.
(vi) Use suitable electrical power protection where available.
(vii) Handle equipment carefully.

D. Troubleshooting simple problems — 3 marks

Relevant points include:
(i) Identify and understand the problem.
(ii) Check power connections and switches.
(iii) Check cables and peripheral devices.
(iv) Restart the computer when appropriate.
(v) Check simple software/settings problems.
(vi) Test whether the solution has worked.
(vii) Report serious faults to the teacher or technician rather than attempting unsafe repairs.

Total: 15 marks